



There are a number of applications in the open source world that are free to use. Many of them perform better than their proprietary counterparts. In this article, the author gives a list of alternatives to proprietary software, covering office productivity tools, browsers, vector art and image editing tools.

Linux is a wonderful operating system and comes with almost everything that a user might require. However, sometimes you might just have to use MS Windows, even though you'd prefer not to — for instance, if your office primarily works with Windows, or you are a gaming fan and prefer to retain MS Windows to play the latest action games. But did you know that even in such cases you can use open source software as alternatives to closed source proprietary options?

Using open source tools and software on MS Windows serves a dual purpose: on one hand, you get the satisfaction of supporting open source and freedom, and on the other hand, you can also save a good deal of money by not relying on highly overpriced proprietary tools.

So let's acquaint ourselves with some of the common and most popular open source alternatives to proprietary software.

1. Libre Office (an alternative to Microsoft Office)

If you are looking for an office and productivity suite that does not burn a hole in your pocket, look no further than Libre Office.

Much like Microsoft Office, Libre Office, too, comes loaded with many tools, including a word processor, a drawing tool, spreadsheet software, a database management application, and so on. However, unlike Microsoft Office, Libre Office is totally free and open source.

Libre Office is cross-platform, and it runs equally well on Linux, Mac and, of course, Windows!

Website: <http://www.libreoffice.org/>

2. Inkscape (an alternative to Adobe Illustrator and CorelDRAW)

Inkscape is a powerful vector graphics editor that offers a wide array of features, including alpha blending, markers, and so on.

If you are someone who works often with Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG), you probably rely mostly on Adobe Illustrator and CorelDRAW. While both these programs are handy tools, Inkscape offers an equally powerful and intuitive solution; yet, it is totally open source and free.

Website: <http://inkscape.org/>